

Frequently Asked Questions For Teams

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A.INTRODUCTION

1. What is the LAWVSMCC?

LAWVSMCC stands for LAWVS Moot Court Competition, an esteemed online national-level moot court competition organized by LAWVS Legal LLP. This competition is a platform thoughtfully designed for aspiring law students across the country to demonstrate and enhance their legal acumen in a simulated court environment. LAWVSMCC not only encourages academic excellence but also promotes professional growth, providing students with an opportunity to interact with and learn from legal experts. By hosting this competition virtually, LAWVS Legal LLP ensures greater accessibility and participation from law schools nationwide, while maintaining the highest standards of quality and competitiveness.

2. What purpose does this competition serve

The primary objective of the LAWVS Moot Court Competition (LAWVSMCC) is to provide a dynamic platform for law students to cultivate and showcase their legal reasoning, research, drafting, and advocacy skills in a professional, yet competitive environment.

Through this online format, the competition aims to:

- Promote a deeper understanding of legal principles and courtroom procedures.
- Encourage analytical thinking and precise legal argumentation.
- Bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application.
- Foster a spirit of professionalism, teamwork, and ethical legal practice.
- Make quality legal exposure accessible to students across the country, regardless of geographical limitations.

3. What is the format of the competition?

The participating teams in LAWVSMCC will present their arguments through both written memorials and oral pleadings, conducted in a virtual courtroom setup. The memorials will be evaluated by a distinguished panel of legal professionals and academicians empaneled as part of the LAWVS Evaluation Committee (LEC). The oral rounds will be judged by experienced advocates, legal scholars, and members of the judiciary during the live online sessions. The assessment will focus on the teams' legal reasoning, clarity of argument, advocacy skills, and their understanding of the relevant areas of law as outlined in the moot problem.

5. Where does the competition take place?

The LAWVS Moot Court Competition (LAWVSMCC) is conducted entirely in an online format, allowing participation from law students across the country without the need for physical travel. All rounds, including the oral pleadings, are held through virtual meeting platforms, ensuring a seamless and accessible experience for participants, judges, and organizers alike. This format not only promotes wider participation but also upholds the convenience and flexibility required in today's digital era.

6. Can I participate offline?

No, the teams can not participate offline.

7. When does the competition take place?

The upcoming edition of the LAWVSMCC is scheduled for 2025, with the Oral Rounds set to take place from Friday, 5th September to Sunday, 7th September.

B. PARTICIPATION AND ELIGIBILITY

8. Which universities are eligible to take part in the competition?

All institutions of higher education offering accredited degrees or qualifications are welcome to participate in the competition. Each

participating team must secure official approval from their respective university or institution before registering.

9. My university gave consent to register, but has now decided to rescind it. What now?

Please contact the Organizing Office as soon as possible at info@lawvs.com. Following steps will depend on what stage of the Competition this takes place in.

10. Can I participate as an individual?

No, individual students may not take part in the Competition, but only as part of a Team representing their university.

11. Can I participate if I have graduated already/will graduate by the start of or during the competition?

Teams must have consent from their university in order to take part. Team members must be actively enrolled students at the time of memorial submission. If a team member graduates before the Oral Round, they may still participate, provided the university agrees to be represented by a recent graduate.

12. What is considered an “actively enrolled student”?

An "actively enrolled student" typically refers to an individual who is currently registered in and participating in academic courses or programs offered by their university. This status indicates that the student is fulfilling the institution's enrollment requirements and is officially recognized as a part of the academic community during the relevant term.

13. Can I participate if I am a student on academic leave?

Yes. It is possible for a student on academic leave to participate if the university supports this and gives its consent to be represented by a student on academic leave.

14. Can I participate if I am an exchange student?

Yes, exchange students may represent the host university.

15. How many people can participate in a team?

One Team may consist of three (3) people at most, including two (2) speakers one (1) researcher.

16. Can team members come from different universities as long as they represent one (1) Team?

Yes, a team may consist of students from different universities, provided that all participating institutions formally agree to have the team represent a single team.

17. How will I know if my team needs to participate in a qualifying round?

You will be informed via email at *mootcourt@lawvs.com* if you are required to participate in the Qualifying Round.

18. How many teams will be participating?

A maximum of 50 teams will be allowed to participate in the competition. Registration will be accepted on a first-come, first-served basis, and only the first 50 teams to complete the registration process will be eligible to compete.

C. CONFIDENTIALITY

19. Why is the competition anonymous?

Maintaining team anonymity helps eliminate bias and ensures that evaluations are based purely on the strength of legal arguments and advocacy skills. This practice upholds ethical standards, minimizes potential conflicts of interest, and reinforces the integrity of the competition by focusing solely on the participants' legal competence.

20. What information are teams allowed to disclose in memorials?

Teams are permitted to disclose only their assigned team number and the specific role to which the memorial pertains. Disclosure of any other identifying information—including, but not limited to, the name of the university represented, the nationality of team members, or any professional affiliations—is strictly prohibited.

21. What information are teams allowed to disclose during hearings?

Teams are permitted to reveal only their designated team number, the role they are presenting, and the names of the counsel and co-counsel. Any reference to identifying details—such as the name of the university, the nationality of team members, or their professional affiliations—is strictly forbidden.

22. Can I share my affiliations with other participants?

Yes, teams are allowed to share their affiliations with other participants, as long as such disclosures are not made in the presence of the Judges.

23. Can I share my affiliations with judges?

No, teams are strictly prohibited from disclosing their affiliations to the Judges at any point during the competition. However, teams may share such information after the competition has concluded or if they have been officially disqualified from further participation.

24. Can I wear any university/country insignia?

No, you may not wear university or country insignia.

25. Can I wear a gown/robe/collar tabs/bands or other legal accessories?

No, participants are not permitted to wear gowns, robes, collar tabs, bands, or any other legal attire, as such items may be considered indicative of their jurisdiction and could compromise the neutrality of the competition.

D. FEES AND REGISTRATION

26. What are the deadlines for registration?

The deadline for registration is the 15th of August 2025.

27. What is a contact person? Who can be a contact person?

The contact person serves as the primary link between the team and the Organizing Office, managing communication, coordinating logistics, overseeing schedules, and ensuring adherence to the rules. They also provide support, address queries, and act as the emergency point of

contact, thereby enhancing the overall competition experience for the team. A team member may be appointed to fulfill this role.

28. What is a Team Number?

Once a team's registration is confirmed, a unique team number will be assigned to ensure the fair and anonymous conduct of the competition. Teams are required to note this number carefully, as it must be referenced in all future correspondence with the organizers.

29. Is there a registration fees?

There is no fees required for the registration.

E. ABOUT MEMORIAL

30. What is a memorial?

A memorial is a formal written submission prepared by participating teams that outlines their legal arguments for both sides of the case—typically the Complainant and the Respondent. It serves as the foundation of a team's case, showcasing their legal research, reasoning, and advocacy in written form. Each memorial includes a statement of facts, identification of legal issues, detailed arguments supported by relevant laws and precedents, and a conclusion with prayers for relief. The memorial is a crucial component of the competition and is evaluated prior to the oral rounds.

31. Can I submit the same memorial for two roles?

No, each memorial serves a unique purpose in the proceedings, contains distinct content, and is intended to present a different legal perspective.

32. How many memorials must each team submit? How long are the memorials?

Each team is required to submit one pdf each for the complainant and the respondent.

33. What is the deadline for memorials submission?

The deadline for submission of the memorial is 20th August 2025, by 11:59 PM IST

34. What must be included in a memorial?

A Written Submission shall consist of the following mandatory heads:

- a. Cover Page
- b. Table of Contents
- c. List of Abbreviations
- d. Index of Authorities
- e. Statement of Facts (not exceeding 2 pages)
- f. Measures at Issue
- g. Summary of Pleadings (not exceeding 3 pages)
- h. Legal Pleadings (not exceeding 25 pages)
- i. Request for Findings (not exceeding 1 page)

33.1. A Written Submission should not exceed the maximum limit of 45 (forty-five) pages in length, including the Legal Pleadings and Cover Page.

33.2. The Cover Page of a Written Submission must contain the following information:

- a. The Team Code in the upper right-hand corner of the cover page.
- b. The name and year of the Competition
- c. The name of the case
- d. The side for which the Written Submission has been prepared
- e. Name of the forum resolving the dispute

35. How should memorials be formatted?

All memorials must strictly adhere to the formatting guidelines outlined in the Rules of Procedure. Any deviations from the prescribed format may result in penalty points, which will be determined by the committee. These penalties will be communicated to the teams before the commencement of the Oral Rounds.

36. What are footnotes?

Footnotes are numerical references placed within the text and detailed at the bottom of the page. They are used to provide citations and supplementary information that would otherwise interrupt the flow of the main content. Footnotes must be used to reference the sources of any statements or legal propositions presented in the body of the memorial. The use of endnotes is strictly prohibited. Additionally, footnotes must not contain substantive arguments or pleadings beyond the citation itself.

37. Can I abbreviate my citations in the footnotes?

The first reference to any source in the footnotes must include the full citation. For subsequent references, an appropriate and recognizable short form may be used. All abbreviations or short forms must be clearly listed and defined in the Index of Authorities.

38.How do I insert a footnote in Word?

To insert a footnote automatically in a Word document:

- Click on the point in the text where the footnote should appear
- Select the “References” tab at the top and then click on “Insert Footnote”
- Type the text you want into the footnote that appears at the bottom of the page

39.Do I need to organize my arguments in a particular order?

You are free to structure your arguments in the manner you find most effective, provided that all the issues raised are thoroughly addressed.

40.Can I use ChatGPT when writing memorials?

Teams are permitted to use ChatGPT and other generative AI tools to assist with research, writing, and editing their submissions. However, if a team chooses to utilize AI, they must exercise particular caution in verifying all cited authorities, as AI-generated content has been known to produce fictional or inaccurate citations. The inclusion of such incorrect or fabricated citations will result in penalties, as outlined in the Rules of Procedure.

41.What would be the most appropriate color for the cover page of the memorial

The most appropriate color for the cover page of the memorial is **blue for the complainant and red for the respondent**

F. ABOUT ORAL ROUND

42.Where do the oral rounds take place?

The Oral Round will be conducted virtually. You will receive the joining link via email or WhatsApp, and you are required to join at the designated time.

43.What is the order of appearance?

Order of Appearance:

1. Complainant Side:

- Lead Counsel for the Complainant
- Co-Counsel for the Complainant

2. Respondent Side:

- Lead Counsel for the Respondent
- Co-Counsel for the Respondent

Rebuttal (optional):

- One speaker from the Complainant may present a rebuttal.

- The Respondent also have a right to surrebuttal (reply to rebuttal)

44. Do I need to organize my arguments in a particular order?

You are free to determine the order in which you present your arguments, as long as all the legal issues raised are thoroughly addressed.

45. How is time allocated?

- **Preliminary Rounds**

Each Oral Pleading Session will be for a period of 60 minutes wherein each Team will be allotted 30 minutes (including Rebuttals or Reply to Rebuttals, as the case may be). Any extension of time beyond this specified period is subject to the discretion of the Panel.

Orator of a Team shall speak for more than 15 minutes, excluding the time reserved for Rebuttals or Reply to Rebuttals, as the case may be.

- **Quarter-Final/Semi-Final Rounds**

Each Oral Pleading Session will be for a period of 80 minutes wherein each Team will be allotted 40 minutes (including Rebuttals or Reply to Rebuttals, as the case may be). Any extension of time beyond this specified period is subject to the discretion of the Panel.

No Orator of a Team shall speak for more than 20 minutes, excluding the time reserved for Rebuttals or Reply to Rebuttals, as the case may be.

- **Final Round**

Each Oral Pleading Session will be for a period of 90 minutes wherein each Team will be allotted 45 minutes (including Rebuttals or Reply to Rebuttals, as the case may be). Any extension of time beyond this specified period is subject to the discretion of the Panel.

No Orator of a Team shall speak for more than 25 minutes, excluding the time reserved for Rebuttals or Reply to Rebuttals.

46.How is time allocated in ex parte hearings?

In the event of the ex parte hearing, the pleading of the team present will be heard and evaluated. Marks will be awarded solely on the basis of their performance, and qualification to the next round will be determined accordingly.

47.Can multiple teammates be present during the main arguments and the rebuttal?

No, only one speaker may present the main arguments and the rebuttal.

48.Can I use PowerPoint during appearance?

No, the use of PowerPoint or other visual aids during appearance is not permitted for teams.

49.Can I speak with my teammates during the hearing?

Any form of written or oral communication between team members and the counsel or co-counsel during the proceedings is strictly prohibited.

50.Can I raise objections / ask questions to other teams during the hearing?

No, you may not raise objections or ask questions to other teams during the hearing.

51.Who can attend the hearings?

Only the designated teammates are permitted to attend the hearing; no one else is allowed.

Furthermore, it must be attended from a quiet, undisturbed room with a stable high-speed internet connection.

52.What is a counsel?

A speaker serving as counsel is responsible for delivering the team's arguments related to their assigned role and for addressing any issues raised by the opposing team during the rebuttal. Researchers are not permitted to act as counsel or participate in oral submissions.

53.What is a co-counsel?

A co-counsel Assist in presenting a portion of the team's legal arguments and may handle specific issues during the oral rounds. While the co-counsel can provide written support during the proceedings, they are not permitted to speak or exchange materials with the lead counsel while arguments are being delivered. In some cases, a researcher may act as a co-counsel, but coaches or assistant coaches are not allowed to assume this role.

54.How early do I need to be in the courtroom?

The teams need to join the link five minute prior to the allotted time and this will be **strictly enforced**

55.What happens if I am running late?

If a team joins the link later than the allotted time, the delay will be deducted from their total pleading time, and marks will also be deducted accordingly.

In case of any technical issue, prior intimation is mandatory. Failure to do so will not be considered an exceptional circumstance.

56.What happens if I cannot make it for a hearing?

If a team fails to join, it will be directly disqualified, and this rule will be strictly enforced.

57.Can I take pictures of / film / record the hearing?

Teams are **not allowed** to take pictures/ film/ record the hearing.

58.Do I need to print my speech or notes?

Yes, you may do so if you wish; However we strongly recommend completing it well in advance, as you will not be permitted to perform any such action during the course of the hearing.

59.Can I use my laptop or other electronic devices during the hearing?

No, use of laptop or any other electronic device during the hearing is **strictly prohibited**.

60.Can I use my phone or smartwatch to time my speech?

The use of phone or smartwatch to time your speech is **strictly prohibited**.

61.Will feedback be provided at the end of each hearing?

Judges will provide feedback solely on the teams' advocacy skills. They are strictly prohibited from commenting on substantive issues. Furthermore, teams are not permitted to initiate discussions with the judges or ask any questions related to the case presented in the proposition.

62.Which team qualify to the QF?

The Preliminary Round comprises both a written and oral phase, and they are evaluated separately. The top eight (8) teams, based on the combined scores from both phases after penalties are deducted, will advance to the Quarter-Final Round. In the event of a tie, the team with the highest total score in the oral rounds of the Preliminary Stage will advance to the Quarter-Finals.

63.How are the QF round generated?

The Quarter – Final matchups will be generated based on the group draw slots.

64.Which teams qualify to the SF?

The four (4) winning teams from the Quarter-Final Round will proceed to the Semi-Final Round. In each Quarter-Final, the judging panel will determine the winning team for that round.

65.How are the SF round generated?

The Semi – Final matchups will be generated based on the group draw slots.

66.Which teams qualify to the Final?

The Semi-Final Round will consist solely of oral pleadings. Notably, scores from written memorials and results from the Preliminary Round, Quarter-Final Round, or any earlier stages will not be considered in the evaluation of the Semi-Final scores. The team that wins each Semi-Final match will advance to the Final Round.

67.How are the Final round generated?

The Final Round matchup will be between the two teams that achieve the highest score in the Semi-Final Round.

G. COMPETITION AFTERMATH

68.Will I receive a certificate of participation?

Each Participant in the Competition will receive a Certificate of Participation upon completion of the Competition and the winner, runner up will receive a merit certificate as well. The Certificate will be drafted in accordance with the full name as provided in the original registration form.

69.When will I receive a physical copy of the certificate of participation?

A physical copy of the certificated will **not be provided**. A soft copy of the certificate will be sent to the email ID submitted at the time of the registration.

70.What materials will I receive following the end of the competition?

- Scoresheets for the Memorials;
- Scoresheets for the Oral Rounds;
- Ranking in the Competition;
- Certificates of Participation for the Team.

71. Will there be a valedictory ceremony?

Yes, a virtual valedictory ceremony will be held at the end of the competition.

72. Who will receive the prize money?

The Winner, Runner Up, Best Memorial, Best Speaker and Best Researcher will receive the prize money.

73. How will the prize money be received?

To receive the prize money, any one member of the winning team is required to share the bank detail with organizing committee

The same shall be followed by the recipients of the Best Memorial Award, Best Speaker Award and Best Researcher Award.

Bank details include;

- Your name as per your bank account;
- Account number;
- IFSC code;
- Bank name;

74. When will the prize money be received by the winner runner up, best speaker, best, memorial and best researcher?

The prize money will be disbursed on the same day following the conclusion of the competition.

H. CONTACT

75. How can I get in the touch with organizing committee?

For any queries, you may contact the Organizing Committee at mootcourt@lawvs.com. While we maintain a presence on various social media platforms, priority is given to inquiries received via email. Kindly ensure that your Team Number is mentioned in all communications with the Committee, and always refer to Team Members by their full names.

76. What constitutes an emergency?

Unexpected events that significantly interfere with the smooth conduct of the competition and call for the Organizing Committee's immediate

response.

These may range from disciplinary issues, late arrivals for hearings, health-related incidents, safety threats, natural calamities, to situations involving fire or dangerous materials.

77.What if I have not yet received a reply to my email?

After you send your email, you will automatically receive a confirmation message indicating that your communication has been successfully received by our team. Please be assured that we are committed to reviewing and responding to all inquiries with diligence and care. However, due to the substantial volume of emails we receive on a daily basis, we kindly request your patience, as it may take several days for us to provide a detailed and thoughtful response. We appreciate your understanding and assure you that every message is important to us.